

Digital Cameras

Cameras are rapidly evolving, and so it's necessary to be up-to-date with the all the features and happenings, and ensure you don't land up with an overpriced camera. Purchasing one has a lot to do with deciding on what kind of camera you need. In this guide, we go through some of the most important points to keep in mind while purchasing a camera.



Lens Parameters

In a Point and shoot (P&S) camera for everyday use, a 3x or 4x optical zoom lens is going to be sufficient for most users. Anything more than that and the camera sizes are bound to increase. There are P&S cameras with 18x and 20x optical zoom as well. These are bulky, but give incredible zoom levels. The sweet spot are the cameras with 6x to 10x optical zoom, which are slightly heavier and bulkier than the standard P&S cameras. The ability to zoom while shooting video is also very important, so be sure that the zoom lens can operate while the video shoots. Some camera manufacturers have lens attachments that can extend the existing lens capability. The cost and availability of these add-ons is worth considering as well.



SLR Lens Comparison

Crop - lens

Zoom lens

Kind Of Cameras

The type of camera you buy solely depends on your needs. If you are a person who carries a camera all the time, then an ultra-compact is what you need. They are typically more stylish, but also expensive. If you like a lot of wildlife shooting or photography in the open of distant objects, then ultrazooms or pseudo-SLRs is what you need. They come with huge optical zooms and are great for shooting distant objects. They also have loads of manual features, and are a good stop before you graduate to a D-SLR. If you want quality and complete control over the camera, then a D-SLR should be considered.

A budget of around Rs 10,000 is sufficient for a decent point-and-shoot camera. If you want something a little more feature-rich, then the budget should be extended up to Rs 15,000. Ultracompact cameras can be priced from Rs 13,000 onwards. Pseudo-SLRs or Ultrazooms start from as low as Rs 13,000. They can go up to as much as Rs 25,000 or so. Full-fledged D-SLR's prices begin from around Rs 29,000.



Ultra-zoom camera



Point-and-shoot camera



Digital SLR

Sensor Size

While image resolutions have kept on increasing, the sensor size has stayed the same. Larger resolutions on the existing sensor sizes lead to gradual degrading of image quality. Larger sensors are expensive. So for the best quality, look for larger sensors in a camera. D-SLRs are known to have larger sensor sizes. In comparison, P&S are much smaller. In that relation, an 8 MP will most likely have inferior quality than a 5 MP D-SLR with a larger sensor.

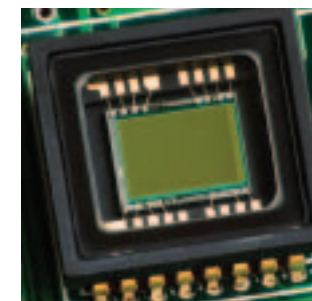
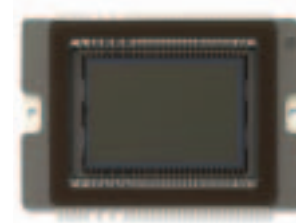


Image quality is linked to the sensor size

Image Stabilisation

Image stabilisation is a must in every camera today, and not something to compromise on. It helps reduce the effects of jerks as much as possible, so you don't get blurry images in low light situations. The feature is also useful while shooting videos.



Megapixel And Resolution

Megapixel is not everything, but is particularly useful if you want to blow up photos or print on large sheets. Any camera more than 5 MP is good enough for most uses — even for large prints. Don't purchase a camera only on the basis of the Megapixel rating for the camera.